

Motivation Letter - Arslan Qaiser - 2026

My commitment to architecture is grounded in a simple historical truth: shelter did not emerge as a tool for financial speculation. The earliest builders did not gaze at a landscape and calculate how to maximize land value for absent investors. They asked a far more fundamental question: How can we alter this earth to sustain our families, protect our community, and endure against the elements?

Over centuries of development, we have witnessed profound changes in why we build. Architecture has been decoupled from its human and ecological origins and repurposed into a vessel for generating capital, gentrification and spatial control. In both my home city of Lahore and global development trends, I see the consequences of this paradigm: urban sprawl squeezing vulnerable populations, natural ecosystems relegated to decorative backdrops, and technocratic gimmickry prioritized over functional resilience. We have come to treat the built environment as a triumph over nature, rather than an extension of it.

This idea, I believe, stems from anthropocentrism—the dogma that human expansion justifies the exploitation of finite systems. Breaking away from this requires an "Anarchitectural" stance: rejecting the doctrine that design exists primarily to serve speculative markets. **Crucially, this lens does not dismantle structural standards refined through practical wisdom;** instead, it questions who these regulations truly serve. When disenfranchised communities build outside formal development pipelines, it is rarely out of disregard for safety, but a rational rejection of a framework that offers them no protection. Seeing past these entrenched market biases requires what historian Ibn Khaldun framed as an unadulterated vision: a "third eye" untainted by institutional dogma.

This systemic breakdown manifests most destructively in the widening gap between design intent and built reality. When safety codes and municipal byelaws are treated as hollow administrative formalities—bypassed or ignored to maximize capital gains and rapid expansion—the built environment becomes dangerous. The flash fire disaster at the Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences (PIMS) in Islamabad starkly illustrates this failure: an oxygen-fed blaze turned a critical ward into a deathtrap due to improper ventilation, unmaintained systems, and passive regulatory compliance. Such tragedies underscore that building codes cannot remain bureaucratic placeholders; they represent a non-negotiable ethical responsibility shared equally by architects, planners, and lawmakers to protect human life.

My professional trajectory as a designer and BIM coordinator is driven by this need for systemic balance. I do not view advanced digital tools—building information modeling, parametric physics, or microclimate simulation—as mechanisms to streamline real estate profits. In my design work, from performance-driven massing and ICF construction details to computational life-support frameworks, I employ my tools as instruments of spatial precision. Such workflows allow us to optimize structural efficiency, minimize resource extraction, and design spaces that respond dynamically to environmental realities.

Quintessential architecture is not about short-lived aesthetic trends or investor yields; it is about maintaining the harmony between person, place, and space. My objective in pursuing the Master Degree in Architecture at Bauhaus—particularly within the focus of Computational Architecture—is to refine the technical, structural, and parametric methods necessary to build environments that shelter communities responsibly, resist financialized degradation, and honor the ecological systems that sustain us.